
ACHYUTARAYA TEMPLE

Hemakuta Hill
Located a short climb away from the Virupaksha Temple is the Hemakuta Hill, which is scattered with a large number of monuments like temples, archways and pavilions. It is one of the best places in Hampi to see the sunrise and sunset.

Achyutaraya Temple
The Achyutaraya Temple is tucked behind the imposing Matanga Hill with an elaborate temple complex and the ruined market street in front of it. Two huge ruined towers, one behind the other, give access to the temple courtyards.

Matanga Hill
Located next to the Achyutaraya Temple, it is also the highest point in Hampi. Matanga hilltop is the best spot to get an aerial view of Hampi and its surrounding areas.

Queen's Bath
This structure has a very plain exterior but the interior is stunningly ornate, with graceful arched corridors, projecting balconies and lotus-shaped fountains that used to spout perfumed water for the ladies of the court.

Lotus Mahal
Lotus Mahal is a graceful two-storied structure, with open pavilions at the bottom and balconies above. The Lotus Mahal is a pleasant departure from the typical architecture in Hampi and is an elegant example of the fusion of the Hindu and Islamic styles of architecture.

Elephant Stables
The Elephant Stables is an impressive structure built during the reign of the Vijayanagara Empire to provide shelter for the royal elephants of the kingdom. This structure has 11 massive rooms with arched entrances, some of which are interconnected.

Pushkarini
Pushkarinis are sacred water tanks attached to temples where devotees used to take a dip to purify the body and soul. The stepped water tank is a tiered structure with steps going down to the water level and is an ode to symmetry with the sides crafted out of rectangular polished black slabs.

Hazara Rama Temple
This was a royal temple reserved for ceremonial use. The entire temple is embellished with bas-relief depicting scenes from the epic Ramayana. The walls of the enclosure are richly carved with friezes depicting processions of horses, elephants, dancing girls, and soldiers attired in splendid weaponry. Inside, four exquisitely sculpted granite pillars add to the beauty of the Ardha Mantapa.

Mahanavami Dibba
Mahanavami Dibba is a beautiful stone platform located within the royal enclosure of Hampi. The kings celebrated the festival of Dasara here. The stone platform is about 12 m high with three layers that are richly decorated with beautiful carvings.

Lakshmi Narasimha
This 6.7 metre monolith statue of Lord Narasimha, an avatar of Lord Vishnu, speaks volumes about the craftsmanship and passion of Vijayanagara artisans. Seated on the coil of Adisesha, the celestial seven-hooded snake, this half-man half-lion avatar still bewitches travellers from around the world.

Kadalekalu and Sasivekalu Ganeshas
Two Ganesha images (Kadalekalu and Sasivekalu) can be seen on the slopes of the Hemakuta Hill. The Kadalekalu Ganesha (Gram Seed Ganesha) is the largest Ganesha statue in Karnataka, dating back to 1440 with a height of 18 ft. The giant statue was carved out of a single huge boulder. Nearby is the Sasivekalu (Mustard Seed) Ganesha that gets its name from the resemblance of the rounded toes to mustard seeds.


LOTUS MAHAL

Atal Bihari Vajpayee Zoological Park, Hampi
The Children's Park cum Mini Zoo, Bellary was relocated to the new Atal Bihari Vajpayee Zoological Park, Kamalapura in Hospet taluk. This new Zoo is situated in Bilikal Reserve forest area. The zoological park, spread over 141.59 hectares, houses wildlife like Crocodile, Blackbuck, Indian Peafowl, Spotted deer, Jackal, Python, Cobra, Leopard, Bear and Wild Boar. It is also home to over 80 species of birds.

Anegundi
Just across the Tungabhadra River is the fortress town Anegundi, pre-dating Vijayanagara and the city's 14th century headquarters. More ancient than Hampi, Anegundi lies in the mythical kingdom of Kishkinda, ruled by monkey king Sugriva (from the epic Ramayana). The Anjaneya Hill, believed to be the birthplace of the Monkey God Hanuman, can be easily spotted from Anegundi, thanks to the temple at the hilltop and a white trail of steps zigzagging all the way to the top. Anegundi and its tranquil surroundings are dotted with forgotten temples and fortifications. The other places of tourist interest are the Huchappayana Matha Temple, sacred Pampa Sarovara, Aramane (a ruined palace) and the Ranganatha Temple.

AROUND HAMPI

Daroji Bear Sanctuary (15 kms from Hampi)
Tungabhadra Dam (25 kms from Hampi)
Kumaraswamy Temple, Sandur (41 kms)
Ballari Fort (60 kms from Hampi)
Sanganakallu (66 kms from Hampi)

WHERE TO STAY

Karnataka State Tourism Development Corporation Limited operates 2 hotels in Hampi namely *Hotel Mayura Bhuvaneshwari Hampi* and *Hotel Mayura Vijayanagara TB Dam.*

Jungle Lodges and Resorts operates the *Hampi Heritage & Wilderness Resort.*

Hampi and Hospet have many accommodation facilities mainly in the budget/ mid priced level. There are limited high end/ luxury hotels which include Hotel Malligi, Hyatt Place Hampi, Heritage Resort, Evolve Back Hampi, Royal Orchid Central Kireeti, Vijayshree Resort & Heritage Village, Kishkinda Heritage Resort, Clark's Inn, Whispering Rocks, etc. Within Hampi, there are many guests houses scattered all over the place that offer modest accommodation facilities.

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